

Plants for clay soil

Clay soil is usually wet, glutinous and heavy in winter, and during drier summers it can shrink and crack, damaging plant roots. Whether establishing a new garden on clay or renovating an older one, always choose plants that will grow well in this type of soil. Prepare the planting area thoroughly, digging the soil in fall, then leaving it over winter to allow the weathering effects of frost and winter rain to break down large clods. Dig in organic matter, and grit or sharp sand to increase drainage. Plant in early spring, at the beginning of the growing season, to avoid losses over winter.



Caltha palustris 'Flore Pleno'



Kalmia latifolia



Anemone hupehensis 'Hadspen Abundance'



Viburnum opulus



TREES

Alnus glutinosa
Betula nigra, p.78
Castanospermum australe
Drimys winteri, p.73
FLOWERING DOGWOODS, p.87
Fraxinus spp., pp.60, 66, 71, 74, 79
Juglans nigra, p.63
Magnolia virginiana
Oxydendrum arboreum, p.76
Pinus sylvestris, p.78
Populus spp. and cvs, pp.60, 61, 62, 63, 74
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Prunus serrula, p.78
Pterocarya fraxinifolia
Quercus palustris, p.66
Quercus robur
Quercus suber, p.78
Salix babylonica var. *pekinensis*
 'Tortuosa', p.80
Salix x sepulcralis var. *chrysocoma*, p.69
SORBUS, p.91

Conifers

Cryptomeria japonica and cvs, p.104
Metasequoia glyptostroboides, p.96
Taxodium distichum, p.99

SHRUBS

Aronia arbutifolia, p.142
Berberis thunbergii 'Rose Glow', p.137
Berberis thundiviana, p.111
Calycanthus floridus
Chaenomeles speciosa 'Snow', p.146
Choisya x dewitteana 'Aztec Pearl', p.122
Choisya ternata **SUNDANCE** ('Lich'), p.148
Clethra alnifolia
CORNUS, p.126
Cotoneaster conspicuus, p.142
Cotoneaster frigidus, p.142
Cotoneaster salicifolius, p.142
Diervilla sessilifolia
Elaeagnus umbellata, p.113
Euonymus europaeus 'Red Cascade', p.140
Euonymus spp., pp.117, 142
Fothergilla gardenii, p.163
Fothergilla major, p.117
Kalmia latifolia, p.136
Mahonia japonica, p.144
Photinia serratifolia, p.111
Photinia x fraseri 'Red Robin', p.111
Rhododendron groenlandicum, p.145
Ribes sanguineum 'Koja', p.146
Ruscus aculeatus, p.167
Salix caprea
Salix exigua, p.112
Salix purpurea
Sambucus racemosa 'Plumosa Aurea', p.139
Spiraea japonica 'Anthony Waterer', p.154
Symphoricarpos albus var. *laevigatus*, p.142
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Viburnum lentago
Viburnum opulus and cvs, p.162
Viburnum tinus 'Eve Price', p.143

CLIMBERS AND WALL SHRUBS

Celastrus scandens
Garrya elliptica 'James Roof', p.211
Humulus lupulus 'Aureus', p.194
Rosa filipes 'Kiftsgate', p.184
Vitis coignetiae, p.209
PERENNIALS
Acanthus mollis 'Holland's Gold', p.219
Anemone hupehensis and cvs
Anemone tomentosa
Bergenia spp. and cvs, pp.255, 256, 280
Chrysosplenium macrophyllum, p.256
Doronicum orientale 'Magnificum', p.263
Eupatorium maculatum 'Reisenschirm', p.221
Filipendula ulmaria 'Aurea', p.274
Geranium 'Orion', p.280
Geranium rozanne ('Gerwat'), p.271
Geum 'Bell Bank', p.268
Helianthus 'Lemon Queen', p.222
Helonias bullata
Houttuynia cordata 'Chameleon', p.444
Iris laevigata
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Leucanthemum x superbum
 'Sonnenschein', p.231
Ligularia 'Britt Marie Crawford', p.445
Ligularia 'The Rocket', p.219
Lythrum salicaria 'Feuerkerze', p.234
Mimulus guttatus
Omphalodes cappadocia 'Cherry Ingram', p.261
Primula japonica
Rodgersia pinnata 'Fireworks'
Trollius spp. and cvs, pp.358, 436, 445

Grasses and bamboos

Luzula sylvatica 'Hohe Tatra', p.288
Miscanthus sinensis and cvs, pp.284, 285, 286
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Ferns

Dryopteris erythrosora, p.293
Polystichum setiferum groups, p.291
Thelypteris palustris, p.291

BULBS, CORMS, AND TUBERS

Cardiocrinum giganteum, p.385
CANNA, p.394
Zantedeschia 'Cameo', p.395

WATER AND BOG PLANTS

Aruncus dioicus, p.436
Butomus umbellatus
Caltha palustris, p.444
Darmera peltata, p.438
Gunnera manicata of gardens, p.443
Lysichiton americanus, p.444
Matteuccia struthiopteris, p.443
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Osmunda regalis, p.443
Pontederia cordata, p.441
Primula florindae, p.445
Ranunculus lingua, p.444
Sagittaria latifolia, p.434
Thalia dealbata

TENDER AND EXOTIC PLANTS

Perennials

Cyperus papyrus, p.478

LEFT A waterside planting

Yellow skunk cabbage (*Lysichiton americanus*) and marsh marigolds (*Caltha palustris*) flourish together in the clay soil beside this stream.